SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

STUDENT SATISFACTION WITH THE LABORATORY SERVICES AND FACILITIES IN THE HOSPITALITY MANAGEMENT

A Thesis Proposal Presented To

The faculty of

College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree

Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management

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JANUARY 2026

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

The hotel and hospitality industry continues to grow rapidly across the world, requiring future professionals to master both theoretical knowledge and practical competencies. As a result, hospitality education is increasingly emphasizing experiential learning, where students develop their skills through realistic and industry-based training environments. In line with this, colleges and universities provide specialized laboratory rooms, such as front-office areas, food- and-beverage halls, housekeeping rooms, and kitchens, for cooking practice. Moreover, well-designed laboratory experiences play a crucial role in strengthening hospitality students' technical skills, learning engagement, and readiness for employment. Research consistently indicates that experiential learning environments allow students to meaningfully connect theoretical knowledge with real-world practice, resulting in deeper understanding and improved performance. In hospitality education, laboratories serve as simulated professional spaces where students develop competencies essential to future careers, thereby enhancing the overall student experience and employability. This relationship also contributes to institutional reputation, as student satisfaction is closely linked to the quality of practical learning environments, and collectively emphasizes the importance of providing safe, complete, and functional laboratory facilities that effectively support the development of essential hospitality skills. (McLeay et al., 2020; Mitra, 2024). Additionally, Arroyo et al. (2023) stated that guided, hands-on practice provides students with the best learning experience. It is also essential to use materials and tools safely. Furthermore, Bueno (2023) and Launi et al. (2024) found that students who are happy with their school facilities tend to do better in class, join more activities, and help build a good reputation.

Additionally, student satisfaction with school facilities is strongly associated with their academic performance, motivation, and institutional loyalty. International studies consistently show this connection. Ren and McKercher (2021) highlight that global hospitality schools with well-designed laboratories and simulation facilities report higher student engagement and stronger learning outcomes because students feel supported by their environment.

Likewise, in the international setting, researchers like Kusumawati (2021) found out that high-quality campus facilities and academic services significantly influence satisfaction, trust, and students' continued enrollment in their programs, while Watson and Clark (2021) argued that high-quality laboratory equipment and materials keep students' attention throughout the learning period. These findings align with the results of Hong et al. (2023) and Wong and Chapman (2022), who emphasize that satisfaction affects more than learning outcomes—it shapes a school's reputation, retention rates, and overall success. Furthermore, it is shown that well-maintained laboratories help students participate more actively, perform better, and stay longer in their programs (Bodinga et al., 2025). Consistently, as Widiarto and Soerjanto (2023) and Gaol and Habiburrahman (2023) agree, satisfaction stems from carefully checking labs, with the condition of facilities and the quality of services being the primary reasons. And that "Practical laboratory experience in hospitality management education significantly enhances students' skill development and prepares them for real-world challenges" (Smith & Johnson, 2020, p. 2).

Meanwhile, in the Philippine context, colleges and universities offering Hospitality Management programs invest in specialized laboratory rooms to strengthen practical learning. These include front-office laboratories, food and beverage halls, housekeeping rooms, and fully equipped kitchens. In support of this, local researchers such as Anselmo et al. (2024) found that students believed their lab work and internships helped improve their technical skills. It is essential to see if school facilities truly meet students' needs, as laboratories play a significant role in hands-

on learning, and student satisfaction helps measure the effectiveness of a school's training in hospitality. Likewise, regulatory bodies such as TESDA (2017) and CHED further encourage schools to upgrade their laboratories to meet global industry standards, emphasizing that quality facilities are essential for producing world-class graduates. Similarly, Peñaredondo (2025) said that having good school facilities helps students think critically, be creative, and work well with others. Students often preferred the cooking area because it had proper tools for an authentic experience.

However, despite these expectations, several local studies reveal ongoing challenges in Philippine laboratory environments that are likewise relevant to individual higher education institutions such as Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC). Koerich et al. (2024) noted that while students may attempt to adapt when space, equipment, or instructions are limited, inadequate facilities generally lead to lower satisfaction and reduced engagement. Similarly, Neri and Faniega (2023) reported that many students expressed disappointment with laboratory conditions, while Fantasia (2024) emphasized that insufficient tools disrupt lesson flow and pose safety risks, particularly in kitchen and housekeeping practices. In contrast, studies show that complete and well-managed laboratories significantly improve student satisfaction and academic outcomes in cooking, food and beverage, and hotel simulation activities (Dela Cruz et al., 2023; Dionson & Tan, 2025). These contrasting findings underscore the need to closely examine the current state of SMCC's laboratory services and facilities to determine whether they adequately support effective, safe, and industry-aligned hospitality training.

Based on the reviewed literature, it is evident that laboratory services and facilities play a crucial role in shaping student satisfaction, skill development, and overall learning outcomes in hospitality education. International and local studies consistently highlight the importance of well-equipped, safe, and properly managed laboratories. However, most existing

studies focus on general facility satisfaction or institutional performance, with limited emphasis on specific laboratory areas and service quality dimensions such as tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. Moreover, there is a lack of localized studies that examine student satisfaction within specific higher education institutions in the Philippines, particularly using a structured service quality framework. This gap underscores the need for institution-based research that evaluates laboratory services and facilities from the students' perspective.

Therefore, this study aims to assess the level of satisfaction of Hospitality Management students of Saint Michael College of Caraga regarding the laboratory services and facilities provided to them. Focusing on the hotel, food and beverage, and kitchen laboratory areas, the research examines essential aspects such as availability, condition, management, and scheduling. As student satisfaction serves as a key indicator of effective learning environments, the study highlights how well these laboratories support the development of technical skills, ensure safety, and contribute to overall academic performance. By understanding students' perceptions, the study sheds light on whether current laboratory provisions meet the standards expected in modern hospitality education.

More specifically, the study aims to determine the profile of respondents based on their program and year level, particularly third- and fourth-year students in Hotel Management, to investigate the correlation between this profile and their satisfaction. It also aims to evaluate student satisfaction with the facilities in the three laboratory areas—hotel, food and beverage, and kitchen—while examining the extent to which service quality attributes are demonstrated in each setting. These attributes follow the SERVQUAL dimensions: tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. By integrating these dimensions, the study explores not only the physical features of the laboratories but also the efficiency, consistency, and supportiveness of the

services students receive.

The findings are expected to guide the institution in enhancing its laboratory facilities and services, strengthening the delivery of hospitality training, and ensuring alignment with national and global industry standards. By addressing service quality gaps and improving laboratory management, the institution can provide more meaningful and industry-relevant training experiences. Ultimately, the results of this study aim to contribute to improved student learning, foster institutional growth, and better prepare graduates for successful careers in hotel, restaurant, and related hospitality sectors.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

This research is anchored on the **SERVQUAL model** developed by Parasuraman, Zeithaml, and Berry (1988) and **John Dewey's Theory of Learning by Doing**. The SERVQUAL model measures the gap between the service that people expect and the service they actually receive, making it a widely used tool for evaluating service quality in settings such as hotels and educational institutions. Dewey's theory, on the other hand, emphasizes that meaningful learning occurs through active participation and direct experience, suggesting that students learn best when they engage in real-life tasks and apply theoretical knowledge through practical activities. In the context of hospitality education, laboratory practices provide the experiential setting where students develop technical skills, professional behavior, and problem-solving abilities. Therefore, the quality of laboratory services and facilities directly affects the effectiveness of learning-by-doing.

For these reasons, the objectives of this study align with the five dimensions of the SERVQUAL model, namely tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy, collectively referred to as the RATER dimensions, which serve as an appropriate framework for assessing students' satisfaction with their laboratory experiences in hospitality management at Saint

Michael College of Caraga across the laboratory areas of hotel, food and beverage, and kitchen. **Tangible** refer to the physical resources that students can see and use, including buildings, equipment, and materials in the front office, housekeeping, and kitchen laboratories, assessing whether these tools are modern, complete, and conducive to effective learning. **Reliability** examines the dependability of laboratory services, ensuring that equipment functions properly and that facilities are consistently available when needed, reflecting the school's ability to provide trustworthy and uninterrupted support. **Responsiveness** considers the willingness and readiness of laboratory staff to assist students, including how promptly they address issues or provide guidance during practical activities, thereby determining the level of support offered in hands-on training. **Assurance** focuses on the professionalism, skill, and knowledge of staff and instructors, ensuring that students feel confident and safe while performing tasks, following proper procedures, and developing competence. **Empathy** evaluates the care, understanding, and concern shown toward students, fostering a welcoming and supportive learning environment, recognizing individual needs, ensuring fair access to laboratory resources, and preparing students for future careers while making them feel valued in the hospitality industry.

The SERVQUAL model helps the research cover laboratory facilities (tangibles and reliability) and laboratory services (responsiveness, assurance, and empathy). The study also collects the critical input of areas to be renovated.

Therefore, the SERVQUAL model serves as a theoretical guide and a valuable tool for this research. It helps measure how satisfied students are with laboratory services and facilities, and how these affect their readiness for future work in the hospitality field.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

This section reviews studies related to student satisfaction with laboratory services and facilities in hospitality education, focusing on respondent profiles, laboratory facilities, and service

quality through the SERVQUAL dimensions, and according to Setiono, Beni (2022), service quality with elements of reliability, responsiveness, assurance, empathy, and tangibles simultaneously affect satisfaction.

BSHM

The Commission on Higher Education (CHED) Memorandum Order No. No. 62, series of 2017, governs the Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management (BSHM) program in the Philippines, providing national policies, standards, and guidelines for the hospitality education sector. This memorandum encourages the implementation of an outcomes-based education framework. Thus, the curriculum's learning outcomes will align with the competencies the hospitality industry demands. In addition, core laboratory courses, such as kitchen operations, food and beverage service, housekeeping, and front office management, must be taught, along with the provision of adequate, functional, and safe laboratory facilities (Commission on Higher Education, 2017). These requirements set the standard for evaluating institutional quality assurance or the institution's readiness to deliver hospitality programs.

Moreover, Neri, Neccesario, and Faniega (2023) noted that Hospitality Management students were quite satisfied with the laboratory services provided, particularly in the kitchen, housekeeping, food, and beverage areas. Still, furniture, maintenance, and air conditioning caused minor student dissatisfaction. The authors cited that CHED's imposition of quality enhancement across all academic institutions was 'in line' with management practices aimed at further elevating student satisfaction. Moreover, Agarpao (2023) was one of the researchers who proposed that BSHM Students' perceived competencies were on par with the National Certification Assessment, and further stated that program-aligned laboratory training can be a tremendous advantage for students' performance and their readiness for national certification and professional practice. It is in accordance with the TESDA (Technical Education and Skills

Development Authority) standard for Food and Beverage Service NC II (2013), which requires schools to have laboratories equipped with industry-grade tools, equipment, and safety features. The requirements of CHED and TESDA complement each other in ensuring that the laborious process of gaining hospitality education through exposure to academic and industry standards is practically painless. The research by Hong et al. (2023) further solidifies the strong link between educational quality and employability, arguing that students' acceptance of the learning environment and the support provided by the institution are significant factors in their preparation for career development.

In a study by Marinakou and Giouspasoglou (2021), it was noted that pleasant and positive experiences in simulated learning environments and internships encourage students to choose the hospitality sector as their career. Experiential laboratories and well-organized instruction in these studies increase students' satisfaction and also develop their professional skills and motivation to succeed in the industry.

Year Level

The degree of students' satisfaction with laboratory services and facilities varies across year levels, as differences in academic maturity and hands-on experience shape individual students' expectations and perceptions. Dionson and Tan (2025) found that there exists a close relationship between the students' practical laboratory experiences and their academic performance in the case of Hospitality Management students, and that students from the upper years with considerable exposure to laboratory tasks tend to score better in theory subjects and critically assess their laboratory experiences more than the students from the lower years do.

Throughout the academic process, students' expectations for laboratories have steadily increased in terms of efficiency, equipment quality, and service. In the study by Diaz et al. (2025), the authors found that students generally accepted staff support during laboratory sessions.

However, the evaluation of the laboratory atmosphere and staff responsiveness fluctuated from year to year. The final-year students were the ones who most desired a more solid, professional, and industry-like atmosphere, reflecting their practicality and readiness for real hospitality situations. This finding suggests that the student's year is a moderating factor in the acceptance judgment, as more experienced students tend to have greater awareness and notice gaps in the facility or service. Moreover, Neri et al. (2023) indirectly suggested that student satisfaction levels in BSHM differed across first-, second, and fourth-year students. Thus, the satisfaction of BSHM students with the laboratory varies by section. Martinez and Santos, as cited by Lago (2025), further support this. Who stated that seniors' involvement and satisfaction were greater due to their increased familiarity?

Moreover, Albarracín et. Al (2024) highlighted the professionalism and competency of the laboratory staff as one of the main factors among the various aspects contributing to student satisfaction. One of their surveys revealed that there is hardly any limit on staff responsiveness and competence, or on their involvement in creating positive learning experiences for students, applicable across the board and at every academic stage. Wong and Chap (2022) also agreed and concluded that interaction quality and institutional support were the principal determinants of student satisfaction in higher education. They observed that teacher-peer interactions are a significant factor in students' motivation and the development of practical skills as they progress through their program. These studies suggest that differences in student satisfaction across years of study are primarily due to variations in students' experiences, skill levels, and lab exposure. For Hospitality Management students, first-year satisfaction may link to instructors' curiosity and the novelty of the "learning by doing" approach. In contrast, for last-year students, it could lean more towards the facilities' standards, service efficiency, and the degree to which lab sessions are like real-world practicing opportunities.

Laboratory Facilities

The availability of laboratory facilities and equipment is crucial to student satisfaction with hospitality education. De Leon et al. (2021) state that laboratory work is highly supportive of students' learning and even their overall development, as it encourages them to inquire, seek answers, perform experiments, and gather data. That is, they have to use the school's laboratories for their practical experience. Likewise, practical learning is central to the nature of Tourism and Hospitality programs and is therefore indispensable (Choi et al., 2021). Besides, Radygina Evginia (2023) stated that practical training for students will be a significant step towards improving graduates' competitiveness.

Notwithstanding, Martinez & Davis in Lago (2025) state that if institutions have quality instruction but are short on physical resources, this might still hinder students' full potential. The statement that sufficiency and quality of laboratory facilities greatly influence the quality of learning, especially in the laboratory classes, was supported by Libres et al. (2021) when they stated that such facilities help to develop students' skills in organizing and classifying information, provide self-satisfaction and reward to students, especially when students complete a project or investigation. According to Ikram et al (2023), students' level of satisfaction with their educational institution is affected by factors including the quality of the facilities available to them.

In contrast, Maramag, Matulin, and Anselmo (2024) note that well-maintained laboratories enhance learning outcomes, enthusiasm, and participation. Mitra (2024) further supports this by stressing the importance of having modern, technology-equipped laboratories in making the learning experience more enjoyable. Sidik et al. (2025) and Rosdiana and Puspita (2022) revealed that cleanliness, accessibility, and equipment availability strongly predict satisfaction. Moreover, Bueno (2023) and Launi et al. (2024) reported that satisfaction with institutional facilities correlates with academic success, engagement, and reputation. Widiarto and Soerjanto (2023) and

Gaol and Habiburrahman (2024) further concluded that facility conditions and service quality best predict student satisfaction, supporting a holistic approach to laboratory evaluation. Hence, the better and adequate the facilities provided, the more student satisfaction increases, which in turn has a positive impact on student loyalty (Putra et. al, 2025).

Hotel Laboratory

Including practical experiences in the hospitality curriculum is an excellent choice. As Neri, Necesario, and Faniega (2023) observed, students' feedback on their front office and housekeeping classes was generally high. However, some of the complaints also concerned the poor condition of the facilities and inadequate ventilation. Maramag et al. (2024) further supported this issue and emphasized that, amongst other things, Academic education integrates realistic front-office setups and additional functional simulation laboratories. Thus, the industry's skills are bridging. Likewise, Mitra (2024) claimed that using the latest industry equipment that mimics actual hotel operations give students a better opportunity to be hired and perform well. These studies, if properly maintained and updated, suggest that hotel and front-office laboratories provide excellent learning sources through experience and help improve student satisfaction. In addition, Kanwa et al. (2023) proposed that the front desk is merely the hotel's facade, shaping guests' perceptions; thus, hotels should adopt new practices to improve service quality while simultaneously attracting guests. All these points show that the students would have an invaluable opportunity to grow through the practice of customer service and professionalism, which are in great demand.

Moreover, Quah et al. (2021) point out that how students perceive a service will determine their level of satisfaction. The more favorable students' feelings are, the more gratified they will be; consequently, this indicates a strong positive correlation between attitude and satisfaction: when satisfaction is high, the attitude towards FOTS is positive. As stated by Azucena et al. (2024),

simulation-based front-office training enhances self-confidence and provides training in communication, decision-making, and problem-solving. Moreover, students say they feel the industry's readiness through realistic simulation. On the other hand, Hong et al. (2023) reported that students' satisfaction decreases when they are not allowed to perform lab work unless some alleviating measures are in place.

Food and Beverage Laboratory

The Food and Beverage laboratory is a space where one receives practical training necessary in hospitality. The first thing Peñaredondo (2025) mentioned was a strong connection between F&B facilities' standards and students' performance, and he also noted that the constant renewal of equipment might become one of the factors that eventually contribute to the outcomes. In line with this, TESDA (2013) has laid down the competency-based standards for F&B laboratories, which, among other things, cover hygiene, quality of service, and safety requirements. The studies conducted by Çelikel Taşcı & Berk (2024), Syuhirdy Mat Noor et al. (2025), and Asmui et al. (2024) identified cleanliness, food safety, and service efficiency as the most critical factors that directly influence patronage in food service settings and, consequently, customers' satisfaction.

In addition, Bacalla et.al (2025) found that canteen cleanliness strongly influences satisfaction, ventilation, and staff attitude, factors that also pertain to F&B laboratory management. On the other hand, Agarpao (2023) argues even more strongly that with a well-structured laboratory training program in accordance with CHED (2017) standards, one gains satisfaction and improved career readiness.

Kitchen Laboratory

For students to perform well, kitchen laboratories should be equipped with complete, specific equipment that would also enhance their satisfaction, according to Vergara et al. Al (2023)

argues that having the right equipment, including cooking equipment, is essential for success and will reduce frustration. Moreover, according to Peñaredondo's (2024) research, there is no significant relationship between the presence of culinary facilities and respondents' evaluation of their academic performance. There is a significant relationship between the functionality and usability of these facilities and academic performance evaluations; however, access to well-equipped, user-friendly culinary facilities is more likely to impact respondents' academic performance positively.

Moreover, Dela Cruz et al. (2023) discovered that the presence and availability of kitchen tools and equipment remarkably influence students' confidence, learning, and satisfaction. Price-Howard and Lewis (2022) and Mitra (2024) noted that simulation-based, technologically advanced laboratories facilitate engagement and master practical skill advancement. As per the research of Maramag and others (2024), kitchens that are both functional and hygienic influence learning results and motivation positively. TESDA (2013) says that for safety and sufficiency to be assured, the culinary infrastructure must be the best in quality and comply with the standards of competency-based training.

The study of Neri et al. (2023) reported that the kitchen laboratory was rated highest across all lab areas in terms of satisfaction. However, they pointed out that ventilation and equipment maintenance were among the problems. The literature agrees that modern, clean, well-equipped kitchen laboratories are necessary for students' satisfaction, academic success, and industry readiness.

Service Quality (SERVQUAL)

The survival, growth, and competition of educational institutions depend heavily on their acknowledgment of service quality and student satisfaction as main values. According to Nguyen (2021), Zeithaml and Bitner (2000) define satisfaction as the degree of fulfillment of a customer's

wants and expectations by a particular product or service. Stankovska (2024) supports this view by stating that the quality of service in higher education significantly influences student satisfaction. Hence, such institutions need to identify the qualities of service they recognize as the source of their students' satisfaction, with the understanding that students, who are the primary recipients of the institution's services, should report these

On the other hand, Putra et al. (2025) pointed out that the services rendered by universities have a profound impact on student satisfaction; thus, the better the quality of service, the higher the satisfaction level of students. Understanding students as customers and fulfilling their various expectations might be the necessary condition for quality service, and the value of the quality service concept in higher education is reflected in its impact on customer (student) satisfaction, loyalty, and consequently, the overall success of educational institutions (Naido et. al, 2024). Moreover, Wael's viewpoint, as referred to by Yusof et al. (2022), stated that Barua and Uddin (2021) established a positive link between the dimensions of service quality that can be directly observed and student satisfaction, while reliability had a significant impact on student satisfaction. Alsheyadi and Albalushi (2020) identified concrete dimensions of service quality reliability, assurance, responsiveness, and empathy that directly influenced student satisfaction. It was also conveyed that Hoque et al. (2023) reported that earlier studies have demonstrated that the high service quality in educational services significantly impacted student satisfaction. Moreover, providing high-quality services that meet or exceed expectations is a reliable way to enhance customer satisfaction (Sian et al., 2023), whereas poorly performed, low-quality services lead to dissatisfaction. Gaol and Habiburrahman (2024) and Rosdiana and Puspita (2022) also found that the interaction of service quality and facility provision is a dual predictor of satisfaction. Diaz et al. (2025) noted that while students appreciated staff support, satisfaction varied with the atmosphere and responsiveness.

The same conclusion was reached by Albarracín et al. (2024) and Wong and Chapman (2022) about the impact of staff professionalism and engagement quality on the level of trust and motivation towards the institution. Also, responsiveness in providing accurate information on service time and request availability, the ability to accommodate specific requests, and the nature of the service provided are among the factors that raise satisfaction levels. Muthia et al. (2025) opined that although tangible aspects are considered necessary in the hotel context, the quality of interpersonal service interactions — such as responsiveness, empathy, and reliability predominantly determines satisfaction.

Nonetheless, Mariyanti, Dewi, and Ximenes (2024) noted that some service quality dimensions (reliability, assurance, empathy) were less important in specific hospitality contexts; thus, the physical facilities may have satisfied customers more. Conversely, Najimdeen et al. (2021) noted that assurance, tangibles, reliability, and responsiveness matter most for service quality and students' satisfaction, while tangibles and empathy stand out as the most important. The service quality dimensions tangibility, reliability, responsiveness, and assurance can serve; however, empathy did not affect students' satisfaction. Thus, these attributes not only point out but also extend and deepen understanding of the service quality dimensions, with students' satisfaction as the main effect (Sohail et al., 2021).

Finally, Widiarto and Soerjanto (2023) and Launi et al. (2024) affirmed that excellent facility management and staff responsiveness lead to customer satisfaction and positive institutional image. Similarly, Bueno (2023) and Hong et al. (2023) established a connection between excellent service delivery

1.4 Schematic Diagram

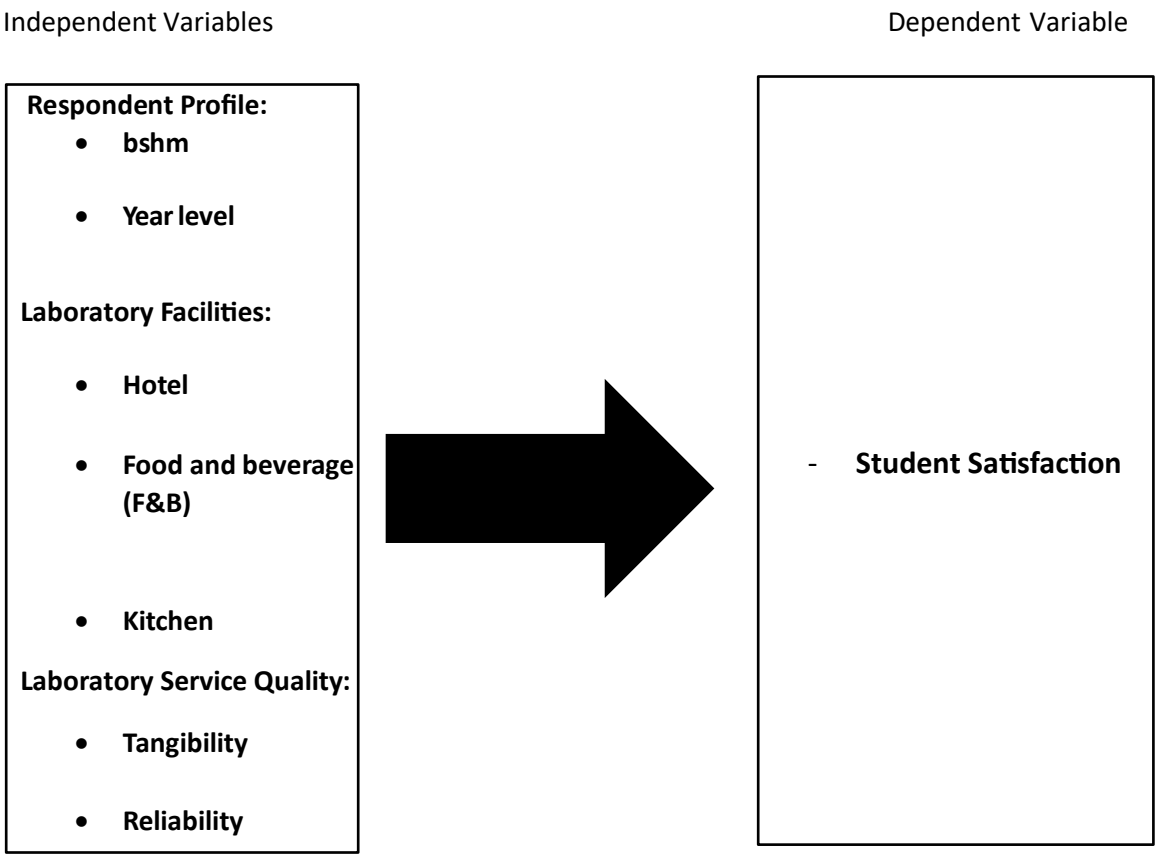


Figure 1. The table presents the variables of the study, examining the relationship between students' profiles, laboratory facilities, and laboratory service quality, as well as the impact of these factors on students' satisfaction. The students' profile includes their program and year level, which may affect their expectations and experiences. Laboratory facilities refer to the hotel, food and beverage (F&B), and kitchen laboratories used for practical activities.

Laboratory service quality is measured through tangibility, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/Objective of the Study

This study will determine the Students' Satisfaction with the Laboratory Services and Facilities in Hospitality Management Laboratory Areas.

Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the profile of the respondents in terms of program and year level?

1.1 BSHM; and

1.2 year level?

2. What is the student satisfaction with the facilities in the following laboratory areas in terms of:

2.1 Hotel;

2.2. Food and Beverage; and

2.3. Kitchen?

3. To what extent are the service quality attributes in the laboratory facilities in terms of dimension

3.1 Tangibility

3.2 Reliability

3.3 Responsiveness

3.4 Assurance

3.5 Empathy

4. Is there a significant relationship between students' profile (bshm and year level)

5. Is there as significant relationship between laboratory facilities (hotel, F&B, and kitchen laboratories) and students' satisfaction, and

6. Is there a significant relationship between laboratory services quality (tangibility, reliability, responsiveness,

assurance, and empathy) and students' satisfaction?

1.6 Hypothesis

Null Hypothesis (H_0)

H_{01} : There is no significant relationship between students' profiles (program and year level) and students' satisfaction.

H_{020} : There is no significant relationship between laboratory facilities (hotel, F&B, and kitchen laboratories) and students' satisfaction.

H_{03} : There is no significant relationship between laboratory service quality (tangibility, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy) and students' satisfaction.

1.7 Scope and Limitation

The goal of this study is to evaluate students' satisfaction with the laboratory services and facilities at Saint Michael College of Caraga in the Hospitality Management program during the academic year 2025-2026. The study particularly examines students' satisfaction with the hotel, food and beverage, and kitchen simulation laboratories, as well as the quality of support, accessibility, and assistance provided by the laboratory personnel. The research, grounded in the SERVQUAL model, unfolds service quality through the lens of the five dimensions of tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy, in order to find out the extent to which these factors impact the students' satisfaction and the preparedness for the hospitality industry.

The population for this research comprises third- and fourth-year Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management (BSHM) students who use the laboratories as part of their educational activities. The investigation will be held at the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management (CTHM) of Saint Michael College of Caraga, located in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte.

The study does not include other institutional facilities such as classrooms, libraries, information technology laboratories, or student support services. It also excludes the assessment

of faculty teaching performance, curriculum design, and instructional methods, as the focus is strictly on laboratory services and facilities. Moreover, factors beyond the institution's direct control, such as students' personal attitudes, motivation, socioeconomic background, and external conditions, including power interruptions, maintenance schedules, or policy changes, are not considered in the analysis. The findings are based only on the data collected during the School Year 2025-2026 and the results might vary in later academic years with upgrades to facilities or changes in administration.

Although the study has limitations, it aims to provide powerful insights into students' views on the adequacy and effectiveness of laboratory services and facilities. The outcomes will serve as a driving force for improving laboratory management practices, aligning academic preparation with industry standards, and enhancing the learning experience of hospitality management students.

Definition of Terms

Assurance. Refers to the level of professionalism, skill, and understanding of the topic demonstrated by instructors and laboratory personnel as determined by students' evaluations of staff confidence, security guidance, and capacity to carry out laboratory tasks effectively.

Empathy. Refers to the degree to which students' perceptions of fairness, accessibility, and care for their learning requirements are used to determine how much individual care, understanding, and support laboratory staff and instructors provide.

Facilities. Refers to the physical resources available in Hospitality Management laboratories, including tools, furniture, and equipment, as measured in terms of adequacy, functionality, cleanliness, safety, and maintenance.

Food and Beverage (F&B) Laboratory. Refers to the laboratory used for food and beverage service training, as measured by students' ratings of cleanliness, equipment quality, safety practices, and effectiveness in developing service-related skills.

Hotel Laboratory. Refers to the simulated hotel practice area, including front office and housekeeping sections, as measured by its realism, accessibility, completeness of facilities, and usefulness in enhancing students' practical learning.

Program. Refers to the academic course in which the student is enrolled, specifically the Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management (BSHM), used to classify respondents for comparative analysis of laboratory experiences.

Responsiveness. Refers to the promptness and willingness of laboratory staff and instructors to assist students during laboratory sessions, as measured by students' perceptions of timely support and problem resolution.

Kitchen Laboratory. Refers to the laboratory used for cooking and food preparation activities, as measured by cleanliness, ventilation, availability of functional equipment, and effectiveness in improving students' culinary skills.

Reliability. Refers to the consistency and dependability of laboratory services and facilities in meeting scheduled activities and providing necessary materials, as measured by students' perceptions of service consistency and equipment availability.

Satisfaction. Refers to the degree of students' contentment with laboratory services and facilities, as measured by their overall ratings of comfort, learning support, and usefulness of laboratories in skill development.

Service Quality. Refers to the overall effectiveness of laboratory services provided by staff and instructors, as measured through the SERVQUAL dimensions of tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy.

Tangibility. Refers to the physical appearance and condition of laboratories and equipment, as measured by cleanliness, modernity, organization, and conduciveness to learning.

Year Level. Refers to the academic standing of the student (third year or fourth year), used to determine differences in laboratory experience and exposure.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter explains the Research Design, Research Environment, Population and Sample, Research Materials and Methods, Research Data and Analysis Plan, and Ethical Standards used in this study.

2.1 Research Design

The study will use a descriptive correlational research design to determine how satisfied Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management students are with the laboratory services and facilities at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC). The descriptive part will present student satisfaction across the Food and Beverage Laboratory, Kitchen Laboratory, and Hotel Laboratory.

The correlational part will examine how various factors, such as facility condition, resource availability, staff support, and accessibility, are related to students' overall satisfaction.

This type of design is appropriate because it helps show the present situation and the relationship between these factors. The researchers will not change or control any variables but will only describe and analyze them. Using this non-experimental approach, the researchers will analyze data to identify which factors most affect students' satisfaction with their laboratory experiences.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

A. Construction/ Origin

This study employs a combination of established and updated methods, and the researchers have obtained permission from the original author. The primary research instrument is based on the survey developed entitled "**STUDENT SATISFACTION WITH THE LABORATORY SERVICES AND FACILITIES IN THE COLLEGE OF BUSINESS LABORATORY AREAS"** by Neri et al. (2023). To enhance its relevance and validity, the researchers will develop a structured questionnaire that will be refined through a review of multiple studies and the application of

service quality models such as SERVQUAL.

The questionnaire has four parts:

Part I — Respondent Profile: Gets information about the students' program and year level.

Part II — Laboratory Facilities: Checks if the hotel, food and beverage (F&B), and kitchen laboratories are enough, easy to use, and in good condition.

Part III — Laboratory Services: Measures service quality using five parts—tangibility, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy.

Part IV — Overall Satisfaction: Find out how happy students are with the laboratory use and how effective it is for their learning.

Answers will be measured using a 5-point Likert Scale:

5 – Very Satisfied, 4 – Satisfied, 3 – Neutral, 2 – Dissatisfied, 1 – Very Dissatisfied

This design helps make sure all critical areas of student satisfaction are covered. The researchers can then study the results to identify patterns and connections among different factors.

B. Reliability and Validity

To ensure the questionnaire yields accurate, consistent results, the following steps will be taken: Experts in the field will review the questionnaire for clarity, relevance, and alignment with the research goals. Changes will be made based on their suggestions before the final version is administered to students. A pilot test will be conducted with 20–30 students who are not part of the leading sample group. The researchers will use Cronbach's Alpha to assess the questionnaire's consistency.

A good reliability score indicates that the tool will produce consistent, trustworthy results. With these steps, the questionnaire will truly reflect how students feel and will provide data that can be trusted.

C. Data Gathering Procedure

The researchers will begin the data collection process by sending a formal request letter to the school registrar, verified by the CTHM Dean, to obtain the complete list of eligible respondents. After validating the population with the statistician, the researchers will finalize the research instrument and conduct validity and pilot testing to ensure reliability. Once the instrument is confirmed accurate, the researchers will request approval from the CTHM Dean to conduct the study. Upon approval, the survey questionnaires will be distributed to the respondents, and the completed forms will be collected, organized, and tabulated. The data will then be submitted to a statistician for verification before being analyzed and interpreted by the researchers.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

The study will be conducted at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC), located at Brgy. 4, Atupan St., Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, specifically within the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management (CTHM) department. In Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, education in hospitality will continue to develop alongside the region's growing tourism and service industries. Saint Michael College of Caraga plays a central role by offering specialized programs such as the Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management (BSHM), which prepares students for careers in this vital sector. The College of Tourism and Hospitality Management at SMCC will focus on providing quality education and hands-on training in hospitality, particularly through facilities such as hotel, food and beverage, and kitchen laboratories. These facilities are designed to equip BSHM students with the necessary skills, competencies, and practical experience to succeed in the dynamic and highly competitive hospitality industry.

Research Population and Sample

The participants in this research are students from the Hospitality Management program, specifically those in their 3rd and 4th years, who utilized laboratories for their training. These students were purposively identified because their level in the program ensures direct, sustained, and recent exposure to laboratory services and facilities, enabling them to provide informed and reliable assessments. A **universal sampling method** was employed in this study. This approach was selected because the total population of third- and fourth-year Hospitality Management students during the School Year 2025–2026 was manageable in size, allowing all eligible students to be included as respondents. By involving the entire population, the study minimized sampling bias and increased the representativeness and validity of the findings.

The researchers will include only officially enrolled students who are willing to participate in the study. Before the survey, the researchers will obtain informed consent from all participants to ensure compliance with ethical research standards.

Table1. Respondents of the Study

Year Level	*Male (f)*	*Male (%)*	*Female (f)*	*Female (%)*	*Total (f)*	*Total (%)*
3rd Year	23	60.53%	18	47.37%	41	53.95%
4th Year	15	39.47%	20	52.63%	35	46.05%
Total	38	100%	38	100%	76	100%

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

This section explains how the researchers will analyze the data collected on student

satisfaction with laboratory facilities and services in the Hospitality Management program.

The researchers used a universal sampling approach to select respondents, as the population was manageable for the study. This means the students will be grouped by year level (third and fourth years).

Statistical Tools Used

To understand the data better, the following will be used:

Frequency and Percentage- to show how many students belong to each year level of the Hotel Management Program.

Weighted Mean- to find the average satisfaction level for each lab (Hotel, Food and Beverage, and kitchen).

Correlation- if there is a significant relationship between the variables in the independent and dependent, as can be seen in problem number 4.

2.5 Research Ethical Standard

The research will be conducted honestly and fairly, in accordance with Saint Michael College of Caraga's Research Ethics Committee guidelines. Before starting, the researchers will get official permission through an Ethics Clearance Application and a Letter of Request to survey students from the Hospitality Management and Seafaring programs. No data will be collected without ethical approval and the written consent of the participants.

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

All ideas, facts, and information borrowed from other writers will be appropriately cited and credited. The researchers will avoid plagiarism and will only use trustworthy academic sources.

Before submitting or publishing the study, the final paper will be checked using plagiarism-detection software to ensure all content is original.

B. Informed Consent

Everyone who joins the study will get an Informed Consent Form. This form will clearly explain the study's purpose, how it will be conducted, and how long it will take. It will also state that joining the study is a choice. Anyone may say no or stop joining anytime without getting in trouble. Only students who sign the consent form will be included in the research.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The study will comply with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (R.A. 10173). The researchers will not share private information such as names, ID numbers, or contact details. The researcher will keep all answers confidential and store them safely. The researcher will use the information only for educational purposes.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

Joining the research will be entirely voluntary. Students can skip questions they do not want to answer or leave the study anytime. No one will be forced, pressured, or tricked into joining.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

The study poses minimal risk because it involves only completing a short questionnaire. The questions will focus on opinions about the school and its facilities, not on private matters. The researchers promise to keep all answers secret and use the results respectfully.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

The findings of this study will help improve the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management's laboratory services and facilities. It will also show the strengths and weaknesses of the current system and support teachers, students, and administrators to work together to improve learning.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

The study will use Stratified Random Sampling to ensure that all students across programs and year levels have an equal chance of being selected. The researchers will not favor or exclude any group based on gender, family income, or academic standing.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

All collected data will be carefully recorded, coded, and analyzed. The researchers will ensure that no cheating, data manipulation, or false reporting occurs at any point. The researchers will double-check all statistics for accuracy before presenting the results.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The researchers will be honest at every step of the research, from collecting data to writing the results. If there are mistakes, limitations, or unexpected results, they will be openly discussed in the final report.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The owners will be asked for permission if copyrighted materials (like surveys, tools, or pictures) are used. All materials and references will be cited appropriately, in accordance with academic standards that respect intellectual property rights.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The study will involve only human participants who will voluntarily complete surveys. There will be no experiments with animals or anything that could cause harm or discomfort to people.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools will be used only to check grammar, format, or organize data. The researchers themselves will develop all the ideas, writing, and analysis to ensure the work

remains original and honest. Any AI-assisted parts will be checked, verified, and appropriately cited.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

The researchers will complete an Ethical Clearance Application Form and submit it to the Institutional Ethics Committee for review. The committee will evaluate the study's objectives, research design, data collection methods, and measures to protect participants' rights. The researchers will also explain how they will secure informed consent, maintain confidentiality, and minimize any potential risks. Once the committee approves the application, the researchers may proceed with data gathering in accordance with ethical standards and institutional policies.

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